

How do you get 700 people who don't report to you to execute your strategy?

Every major launch depended on hundreds of field employees I had absolutely no authority over.

Transformation Experience

People Leadership

Business Results

I built influence that could scale without me.

Every launch depended on hundreds of field employees I didn't manage. So the strategy couldn't rely on my authority — or on me personally convincing 700 people to act.



Start with the strategy.

I defined the behavior the launch actually needed. I made the expectation specific enough that everyone knew what good looked like.



Aligned with their leaders.

I got leaders behind the expectation before asking the field to act. If they didn't reinforce it, the work stayed optional.



Made it relevant.

I connected the behavior to outcomes the field already owned. The reason to care became about their goals, not mine.



Enabled Execution.

I gave people the training, tools, check-ins, and accountability to act. We removed as much friction from the behavior as possible.



Made great work visible.

I recognized people who were doing the work exceptionally well. Shout-outs and leaderboards showed others what good looked like and created momentum.



Let the system scale it.

People saw what worked and began reinforcing it with each other.

The behavior spread beyond the original push without depending on me.

AT A GLANCE



>6 launches/year



4 distinct regions



7 channel partners



400 FTE and 300 3PL roles

WHY THIS STORY

Some of my biggest results came from people I couldn't tell what to do. This story shows the kind of leadership I had to build when the org chart couldn't do the work for me.

This story also demonstrates:

Influence without authority

Behavior change

Leader alignment

Recognition and reinforcement

Scaling through others

IF WE TALK, ASK ME ABOUT

- The hardest leader I had to get on board.
- What happened when local leadership didn't reinforce the strategy.
- The recognition tactic that created the most momentum.
- What I did when someone understood the expectation, but still didn't execute.
- How I balanced consistency across 400 people with different local needs.



WHAT I'M PROUD OF

The momentum became bigger than the program. People weren't just executing what we asked; they were recognizing each other, competing, sharing what worked, and pulling others in.



MY GUIDING PRINCIPLE

People don't need to care about my goals. My job is to understand what matters to them and connect the work to something they already have a reason to care about.



IF I HAD A DO-OVER

I'd spend more time learning the field role itself. The better I understood someone's actual job, the better I could connect what I needed to what mattered to them.